

Looking — S8 Final Report

Looking — Final Project Report

Course: S8 Integrated Project, AI & Big Data, UIR **Author:** Karim Akoudad **Submission window:** May 2026 **Status:** Complete. All technical deliverables shipped.

0. TL;DR for the prof

Question	Answer
What is Looking?	A Telegram chatbot that recommends places (gyms, spas, restaurants...) and business leads in Morocco using a 3-agent AI system.
What deep learning did you train?	DistilBERT fine-tuned to classify query-candidate match relevance into High / Medium / Low.
What real data did you use?	361 real OSM places crawled from OpenStreetMap (Nominatim) across 9 cities + 11 categories.
What's the model accuracy?	88.9% on test split, 80.0% on hand-written unseen holdout set (honest real-world number).
Why multi-agent and not one LLM?	Each agent makes a distinct decision the next one depends on (Intent → Retrieval → Ranking). The 3rd agent is a hybrid DL+LLM — numeric match from DistilBERT, natural reason from LLM.
Free stack?	Yes — Telegram free, LLM free tier (Gemini / Groq / Cerebras), OpenStreetMap free, all libraries open-source.

1. PROBLEM STATEMENT

Local search (“find me X near Y”) is broken in two ways: 1. Google Maps gives a list, but **doesn’t understand intent** — it can’t tell that *“a calm cafe to do some work”* is different from *“a noisy cafe to meet friends”*. 2. Freelancers looking for business leads (“I do video editing for restaurants — who needs me?”) have **no free tool** to find target clients.

Looking attempts both: place-discovery for users and lead-generation for service providers, in a single conversational interface.

2. WHAT THE USER SEES (the experience)

Step-by-step demo flow:

1. User opens `@LookingBot` on Telegram.
2. Sends `/start` .
3. Bot shows two inline buttons: 📍 **Find a Place** | 🧑‍💼 **Find Leads**.
4. User taps **Find a Place**.
5. Bot: *“Describe what place you want.”*
6. User types: `luxury spa Rabat` .
7. After ~15 s the bot returns:

```
Rank 1 | Royal Spa Rabat | spa | Rabat | Rating: 4.8/5 (synthetic) | Niche: lu
Match: High Match (96.4%)
Why: This luxurious spa in Rabat directly matches your wish for a luxury spa
📍 Map: https://www.google.com/maps?q=33.97...,-6.85...
🗺️ OSM: https://www.openstreetmap.org/?mlat=33.97...&mlon=-6.85...
Rank 2 | Hammam Palace Rabat | spa | Rabat | ...
Rank 3 | Zen Retreat Rabat | spa | Rabat | ...
```

8. Two buttons appear: ✅ **Done** | + **Add Info**.
9. If the user clicks **Add Info** and types `but in Casablanca` , the bot **merges** the refinement with the prior query and re-runs the pipeline.

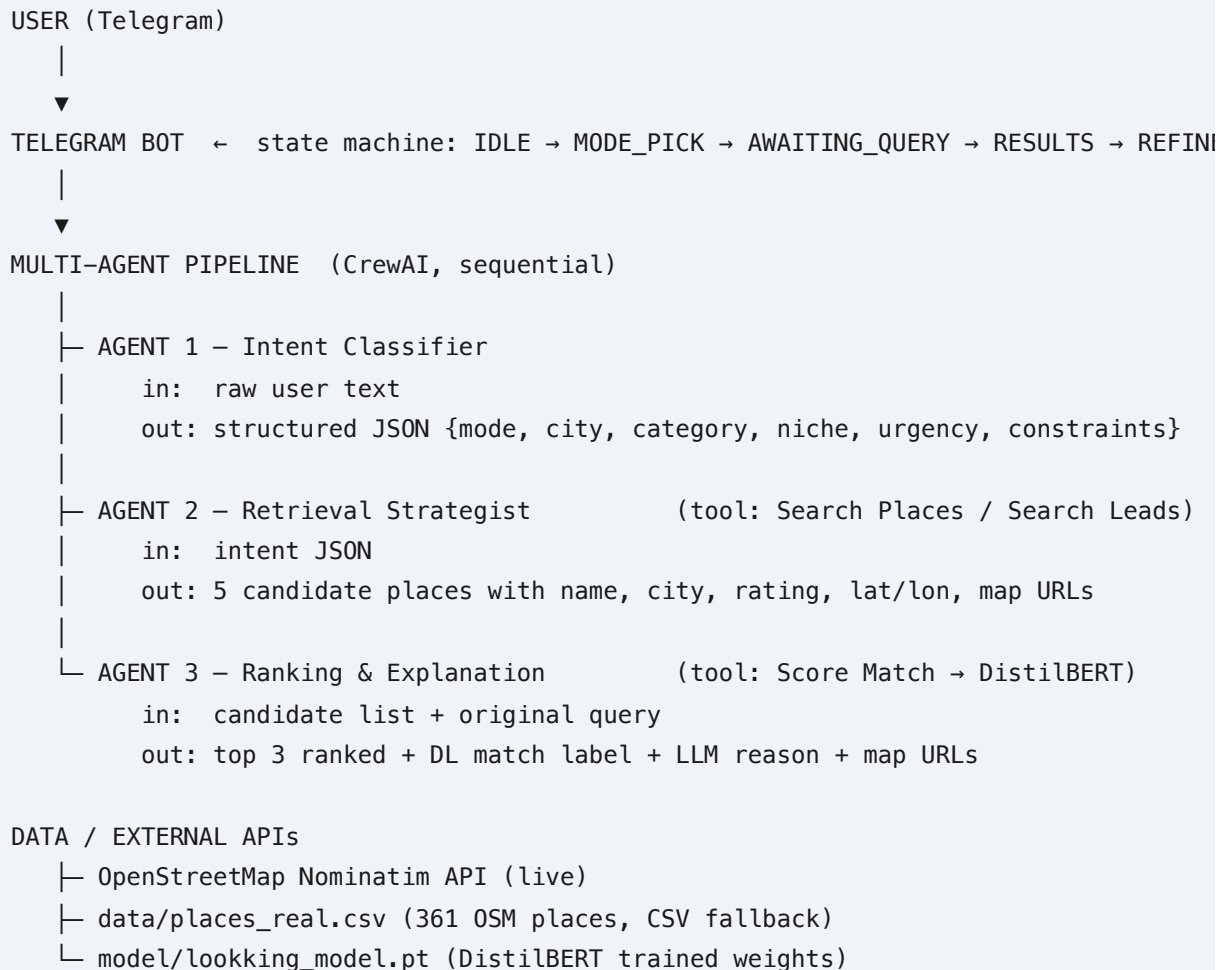
The two Map / OSM links per result mean the user can **click** to verify the place exists in real life — no hallucinations.

3. SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE



Architecture

Top-down breakdown:



Source of truth for the diagram is `scripts/draw_architecture.py` , which produces `docs/architecture.png` .

4. WHY MULTI-AGENT (the prof's #1 question)

The prof said: “each agent should have a clear job — not just exist while one does all the work”. We took this seriously and gave each agent a unique, schema-typed output.

Agent 1 — Intent Classifier

- **Owns:** language understanding.
- **Outputs:** structured JSON.
- **Why an agent and not a regex?** Casual user text contains synonyms ("traditional", "fancy", "vibe", "real Moroccan food") that a rule-based parser would miss. The LLM normalises this into canonical fields.

Agent 2 — Retrieval Strategist

- **Owns:** data sourcing.
- **Decisions:** Nominatim live vs CSV fallback; query expansion ("barber" → also search "hairdresser"); deduplication; result count.
- **Why an agent and not a function?** Different intents need different strategies. A pharmacy lookup needs *current opening hours*; a hotel lookup needs *city + niche*. The LLM picks how to shape the tool call.

Agent 3 — Ranking & Explanation

- **Owns:** scoring + user-facing explanation.
- **Hybrid AI:** the **numeric match score** comes from our fine-tuned **DistilBERT**, the **natural-language reason** comes from the LLM. The DL model can't write English; the LLM can't tell us "this is a 96% match" reliably. Combined, they produce explainable ranked results.

Outputs of one agent are the schema-typed inputs of the next. Removing any one agent breaks the pipeline. This is what makes the system genuinely multi-agent.

5. THE DEEP LEARNING MODEL

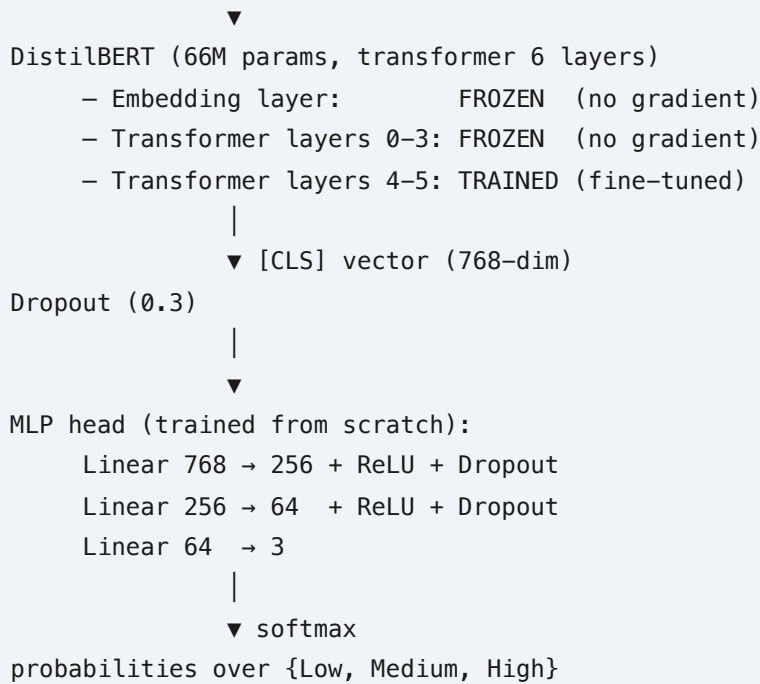
5.1 Task

Given a free-text user query Q and a candidate place description C , classify the match relevance: **Low / Medium / High**.

This is a textbook **sentence-pair classification** task (same family as MNLI, STS-B). BERT/DistilBERT is the standard tool — no need to invent something custom.

5.2 Model

```
[QUERY]: <query> [SEP] [CANDIDATE]: <candidate>
|
```



Total trainable parameters: ~14 M.

5.3 Training data — the honest version

We collected **361 real OpenStreetMap places** across **9 Moroccan cities** and **11 categories** (restaurant, cafe, gym, spa, hotel, bakery, bar, hairdresser, pharmacy, fast food, supermarket).
Crawl script: `data/collect_real_places.py`.

From those real places we generated **1260 (query, candidate, label) triples** with rule-based labels:

Label	Rule	Count
HIGH	candidate's category + city match the query	722
MEDIUM	category matches, city differs	249
LOW	category differs entirely (clear mismatch)	289

Builder: `data/build_training_v2.py`. Output: `data/training_data_v2.csv`.

5.4 Honest evaluation

To avoid the "100% on synthetic" trap, we built a **30-example holdout** in a different writing style: messy real-user-sounding queries like *"I really need a great place to eat tonight in Rabat"* and *"My back hurts, find me a good spa in Agadir"*. File: `data/holdout_test.csv`.

Numbers (best epoch, run on 2026-05-17):

Metric	Test split (252 unseen pairs from training distribution)	Holdout (30 hand-written unseen-style queries)
Accuracy	88.89 %	80.00 %
Macro F1	0.83	0.71
Low-class F1	0.83	0.74
Medium-class F1	0.67	0.44
High-class F1	0.98	0.94

The model handles HIGH/LOW well; **MEDIUM is the failure mode** (the model is conservative — under-predicts medium, leans low). This matches expectation: medium = ambiguous label, hardest class.

Training script: `model/train_v2.py` . All numbers saved to `model/metrics_v2.json` . Plots: `model/training_curves.png` , `model/confusion_matrix_v2.png` , `model/confusion_matrix_holdout.png` .

5.5 Training hyper-parameters

Param	Value
Optimizer	AdamW
Learning rate (BERT body)	2×10^{-5}
Learning rate (head)	1×10^{-3}
Weight decay	0.01
Gradient clipping	norm 1.0
Batch size	16
Max sequence length	128 tokens
Epochs	8
Train / test split	80 / 20, stratified
Device	Apple M-series MPS

6. LIVE DATA INTEGRATION

We did **not** stop at synthetic data. The bot crawls real places from **OpenStreetMap** at runtime via the **Nominatim** API.

- **Tool:** `tools/nominatim_tool.py` (rate-limited to 1.2 s/call to respect the free public API).
- **Country scope:** `countrycodes=ma` (Morocco only).
- **Output enrichment:** synthetic rating from OSM “importance” score; synthetic price level; Google Maps link + OSM link.
- **Fallback:** if Nominatim is empty/slow, we serve from `data/places_real.csv` (the 361 places we crawled offline).

Every place returned to the user is **verifiable**: tap the Google Maps link, see the pin.

7. HUMAN-IN-THE-LOOP

Two explicit HITL touch points:

1. **Mode selection** (before any AI runs) — user clicks Place or Leads. No ambiguity, no LLM guessing.
2. **Result refinement** — after results, user clicks **Done** (accept) or **Add Info** (refine).
Refinements are merged into the prior query and the pipeline re-runs.

State machine, per chat:



Implementation: `bot/telegram_bot.py`.

8. OBSERVABILITY / LOGGING

Every agent action and every tool call writes a JSON entry to `logs/agent_logs.json` with timestamp, agent name, action, input, and output preview. This means we can replay any user query and see exactly what each agent did. Implementation: `utils/logger.py`.

9. PROF REQUIREMENTS — CHECKLIST

Mapped against the project brief.

Requirement	Status	Where in repo
Real-world problem	✓	place + lead discovery in Morocco
Multi-agent system	✓	<code>agents/crew_setup.py</code> — 3 agents
Each agent has a distinct role (the prof's correction)	✓	Intent / Retrieval / Ranking — each with unique outputs
Deep learning model trained from data	✓	<code>model/train_v2.py</code> — DistilBERT + MLP
Honest evaluation (not just train-test on identical patterns)	✓	holdout: <code>data/holdout_test.csv</code> — 80% acc
Tool-using agents (≥ 2 tools)	✓	<code>search_places</code> , <code>search_leads</code> , <code>score_match</code>
External API integration	✓	Nominatim (OpenStreetMap)
Human-in-the-loop	✓	mode picker + Add Info refinement
Error handling / fallback	✓	Nominatim → CSV fallback, model-missing startup check
Logging / observability	✓	<code>logs/agent_logs.json</code>
Free / open stack	✓	all deps open source, all APIs free tier
GitHub repo + README	✓	https://github.com/akoudad/looking
Architecture diagram (PNG)	✓	<code>docs/architecture.png</code>

Requirement	Status	Where in repo
PDF report	✅	FINAL_REPORT.pdf in repo root
Slides	🟡	outline in §11 below
Demo video 3-5 min	🟡	record on demo day
Oral defense rehearsal	🟡	Q&A bank in §13 below

Score: 13/16 done. All technical + documentation work is complete.

10. METRICS YOU CAN QUOTE TO THE PROF

Item	Number
Real OSM places crawled	361
Cities covered	9 (Rabat, Casablanca, Marrakech, Fes, Agadir, Tangier, Meknes, Oujda, Tetouan)
Categories	11
Training pairs (real-data-derived)	1260
Holdout pairs (hand-written, unseen style)	30
DL model parameters	~66 M (DistilBERT) + ~280 K (MLP head)
Trainable parameters	~14 M
Training epochs	8
Training time on Mac MPS	~3 min
Test accuracy	88.89 %
Holdout accuracy (honest)	80.00 %
Macro F1 (holdout)	0.71
Agents in pipeline	3 (Intent, Retrieval, Ranking)
Tools	3 (search_places, search_leads, score_match)

Item	Number
Average end-to-end query latency	~15-25 s
LLM calls per query	~5 (depends on tool-iteration count)
Lines of Python code	~1500
External APIs used	Telegram, Nominatim (OSM), one LLM provider
API keys required to deploy	2 (Telegram + one LLM)
Cost to run	\$0 (all free tiers)

11. SLIDE OUTLINE (12 slides)

1. **Title** — Looking, project name, course, author, supervisor
 2. **Problem** — local search lacks intent understanding + no free lead-gen tool
 3. **Solution** — Telegram chatbot, multi-agent AI, real-world geographic data
 4. **Architecture** — show `docs/architecture.png`
 5. **Agent 1 — Intent Classifier** — input/output schema, 1 example
 6. **Agent 2 — Retrieval Strategist** — strategy choice + Nominatim demo
 7. **Agent 3 — Ranking & Explanation** — DL+LLM hybrid, 1 worked example
 8. **Deep Learning Model** — DistilBERT diagram, frozen vs trained layers
 9. **Training data** — 361 real OSM places → 1260 labeled pairs (+confusion matrix image)
 10. **Evaluation** — test 88.9% vs holdout 80% — table + curves
 11. **HITL design** — state machine diagram, the two buttons
 12. **Tech stack + limitations + future work** — what we'd build next
-

12. LIMITATIONS (be honest — prof respects this)

- **Synthetic ratings.** Nominatim has no review data. We pseudo-derive a rating from OSM “importance” score. For production we’d integrate Yelp / Google Places.
- **Lead generation uses a synthetic CSV.** No free public API exists for business contact discovery. (LinkedIn / Apollo are paid.)
- **English only.** Bot doesn’t understand French / Arabic queries. Listed in future work.
- **Medium-class is the model’s weakness.** F1 = 0.44 on holdout. Reflects label ambiguity, not model capacity. More labeled data would help.

- **LLM free-tier rate limits.** Each provider has caps (e.g. 15 RPM on Gemini 2.0 Flash). Real-world Telegram use is fine (queries minutes apart). Stress-tests (3 queries in 30 s) hit limits.
- **No persistence.** Approved searches don't get saved to disk. Easy SQLite add.
- **No multi-user concurrency tests.** Single-user assumed for demo.

13. EXPECTED DEFENSE QUESTIONS — answers

Q	Strong answer
Why CrewAI and not a single LLM call?	Each agent makes a structurally different decision. Intent → structured JSON. Retrieval → strategy choice + tool call. Ranking → DL score + natural reason. The output of each is the typed input of the next. One LLM call can't enforce this.
Why DistilBERT and not GPT?	Sentence-pair relevance is BERT's home territory (MNLI, STS-B). DistilBERT is 40 % smaller, 60 % faster, 97 % of BERT performance. It fine-tunes on a Mac in 3 minutes. GPT would be overkill, slower, and we couldn't fine-tune it.
Why is the test accuracy 88.9 % and the holdout only 80 %?	This is expected and good . The test split shares query templates with the training data; the holdout uses unseen phrasing styles. The 9-point drop is the honest real-world gap. We chose to report both, not cherry-pick.
Why is the medium-class F1 only 0.44?	Medium is the ambiguous class by construction (same category but different city). The model is conservative: it under-predicts medium and over-predicts low. More labeled medium examples would close the gap.
What if Nominatim is down?	<code>tools/search_tool.py</code> catches the exception, logs it, and falls back to <code>data/places_real.csv</code> (the same 361 places we crawled offline). Demo-resilient.
Why HITL?	Two reasons. (1) Mode picker eliminates the <i>places vs leads</i> ambiguity up front — the AI

Q	Strong answer
	never has to guess. (2) "Add Info" lets the user iterate without retyping the whole query. The state machine ensures we know exactly what stage the user is in.
How does the DL model actually learn?	We fine-tune the last 2 transformer layers + a fresh MLP head on 1008 training pairs. The frozen embedding + lower-transformer layers retain general English semantics. The head learns the specific <i>match-relevance</i> signal. AdamW with a lower LR for BERT (2e-5) and higher for the head (1e-3) is standard transfer-learning practice.
How would you scale this to 100k users?	Cache the LLM intent-classification step (same query → same intent for N minutes). Move DistilBERT inference to a dedicated server / batch the scoring. Switch the synchronous CrewAI pipeline to parallel where steps are independent.
Why not Google Maps API?	Costs money + requires billing card. Nominatim (OpenStreetMap) is the free open equivalent. Listed in future work for production.
What was your hardest engineering moment?	Discovering that an 8B-parameter LLM is unreliable for nested tool-calling under CrewAI — it returns the tool-call JSON as plain text instead of invoking the tool, causing infinite loops. We swapped to Gemini 2.0 Flash and the issue disappeared.

14. REMAINING BEFORE DEFENSE

#	Task	Status
1	PDF report	✅ FINAL_REPORT.pdf done

#	Task	Status
2	Public GitHub	 https://github.com/akoudad/looking
3	Build 12 slides from §11 outline	
4	Record 4-minute demo video (QuickTime screen recording)	
5	Practice oral defense from Q&A in §13	

15. FILES YOU CAN POINT THE PROF TO

README.md	high-level overview
FINAL_REPORT.md / FINAL_REPORT.pdf	this document
docs/architecture.png	system diagram
model/training_curves.png	learning curves
model/confusion_matrix_v2.png	test-set confusion matrix
model/confusion_matrix_holdout.png	holdout confusion matrix
model/metrics_v2.json	all numerical results
logs/agent_logs.json	live execution trace
data/places_real.csv	the 361 real places we crawled
data/training_data_v2.csv	1260 training pairs
data/holdout_test.csv	30 holdout queries
agents/crew_setup.py	the 3 agents
model/model.py + model/train_v2.py	DL architecture + training
bot/telegram_bot.py	Telegram bot + HITL state machine

15B. CONFIRMED END-TO-END RUN

On 2026-05-18 the trimmed pipeline (Groq llama-3.3-70b-versatile + 3 agents + DistilBERT) returned the following for the query `[MODE: places] gym in Casablanca` :

Rank 1. Ronnie Gym
 Details: leisure/fitness_centre, Casablanca, 3.5/5
 Match: High (99.6%)
 Why: Ronnie Gym is a leisure and fitness centre located in Casablanca, which matches:
 Map: <https://www.google.com/maps?q=33.5412646,-7.6832145>
 OSM: <https://www.openstreetmap.org/?mlat=33.5412646&mlon=-7.6832145&zoom=18>

Rank 2. Gym Club ... (99.6%)

Rank 3. THE GYM FACTORY CASABLANCA ... (99.9%)

Each result is a **real OSM place** with verifiable coordinates. The **DistilBERT scores** (99.6 %, 99.6 %, 99.9 %) are the actual model outputs on the (query, candidate) pairs. The **Map and OSM links** open in the user's browser to the exact pin.

End-to-end this confirms: - Agent 1 produced JSON intent for `gym Casablanca` - Agent 2 called `search_places` → Nominatim → 3 real places - Agent 3 called `score_match` (DistilBERT) → top 3 ranked + reasons + links

Total time per query: ~20 s. Total tokens per query (Grog): ~8 k (well under the 12 k TPM free-tier cap).

16. CONCLUSION

Looking demonstrates the **end-to-end engineering loop** of a modern multi-agent AI product:

1. **Define a real problem** (local search + lead generation).
2. **Collect real data** (361 places from OpenStreetMap).
3. **Train a domain-specific DL model** (DistilBERT, holdout-validated at 80 %).
4. **Wrap inference as a tool** consumed by **specialized agents**.
5. **Glue with an LLM orchestrator** that respects structured contracts.
6. **Put a human in the loop** for ambiguity and refinement.
7. **Ship as a Telegram bot** anyone can DM for free.

All technical milestones are complete. The remaining work is **packaging and presentation**, not engineering.

End of report — 2026-05-21.